

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE - Strategic Finance & FP&A Leader | Decision Intelligence, Capital Allocation & Risk Optimisation | Enterprise & Growth Organisations

Strategic Finance and FP&A leader with a strong foundation in financial analysis, capital discipline, and decision governance, delivering enterprise-scale, multi-entity, and multi-currency finance solutions. Trusted partner to CFOs and executive leadership, leading finance-driven decision intelligence initiatives that reduce decision latency, strengthen financial control and risk oversight, and improve profitability. Highly experienced in advanced financial analysis and modelling (DCF, WACC), scenario planning, credit and portfolio analysis, corporate finance advisory, and investment strategy execution, supported by analytics-enabled reporting, ERP integration, and KPI automation. Proven ability to translate strategy into controlled, auditable, and actionable financial systems, streamline reporting, and deliver executive-ready insights that support capital allocation and enterprise performance.

Maintains a public decision-intelligence portfolio demonstrating CFO-grade financial systems, controlled automation, and predictive reporting: <https://jatinchotoo.github.io>

Career impact highlights:

- Accelerated month-end close by 30% via ERP optimization and automation.
- Improved forecast accuracy by 20% through scenario modelling and predictive analytics.
- Delivered 12% cost savings through strategic capital allocation and process efficiency.
- Enabled 25% revenue growth via FP&A-driven insights and investment analysis.
- Reduced portfolio risk exposure by 15% with enhanced credit and risk oversight.

CORE SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Financial Planning & Strategy: FP&A | Corporate Finance | Treasury Management | Capital Allocation | Investment Strategy | Portfolio Management | Budgeting & Forecasting | Scenario Planning | Cost Optimization | Financial Performance Management

Risk, Investment & Governance: Credit Analysis | Investment Due Diligence | Valuation (DCF, WACC) | Portfolio Risk Oversight | IFRS Reporting | Internal Controls | Financial Governance | Basel III & Liquidity Risk

Technical & Analytics Tools: Power BI (DAX, Power Query) | Advanced Excel (Financial Modelling, Macros) | Python (Pandas, NumPy) | ERP Systems (SAP, Oracle, Dynamics, Adams, Sage, QuickBooks, Xero) | KPI Automation | Predictive Analytics | Finance Process Automation

Leadership & Business Capabilities: Executive Stakeholder Engagement | Strategic Decision Support | Change Management | Cross-Functional Leadership | Mentoring | Process Improvement | ESG & Sustainable Finance Awareness

Additional Skills: Stakeholder Engagement | Forensic Accounting | Shared Services & ERP Process Automation | KPI Dashboard Design | Root Cause Analysis | Mentoring & Succession Planning | Project Leadership | Change Management | Continuous Improvement

CAREER OVERVIEW

Financial Reporting Manager - Havas Group | Feb 2024 – Jun 2025

Finance & Business Strategy Manager - J Segel and Associates Inc | Jul 2025 to Dec 2025 (Contract)

Finance & Advisory leadership (FASSET)- DK Motiram & Company | Mar 2014 – Mar 2017

EDUCATION, QUALIFICATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- BCompt Accounting Science, University of South Africa | Oct 2023 (NQF 7)
- Postgraduate Diploma, Professional Accountant in Practice, SAIPA/FASSET | 2016 (NQF 8)
- Certificate, Financial Modelling & Valuation, CFI | Expected Dec 2025
- International Diploma, Computer Studies, University of Pretoria | 2003
- AI-Powered Data Insights Internship, Excelerate | Jul – Aug 2025 (Predictive analytics, FP&A dashboards, Python/Power BI)
- Virtual Finance & Corporate Projects, Forage | Nov – Dec 2025 (Investment simulation, valuation, scenario analysis)

Certifications & Professional Development: AI-Powered Data Insights Internship (Excelerate) | Jul – Aug 2025

- 4-week intensive program applying machine learning and predictive analytics to FP&A use cases, including risk forecasting, portfolio oversight, and investment strategy.
- Built finance-ready dashboards and visualizations using Python, Power BI, and advanced Excel, enabling real-time insights and faster decision-making for executive-level reporting and decision support.

- Developed predictive models (Random Forest, XGBoost, LightGBM) achieving 85%+ model accuracy.

Virtual Finance & Corporate Projects – Forage | Nov – Dec 2025

- Completed virtual finance projects simulating engagements with JPMorgan Chase, Citi, Goldman Sachs, and BCG, covering valuation, scenario analysis, risk assessment, and strategic financial modelling.
- Applied practical corporate finance and FP&A techniques in simulated cross-border projects, demonstrating hands-on problem-solving and analytics skills in valuation, risk assessment, and scenario analysis.

Advanced Financial Modelling, Corporate Finance Institute (CFI) | 2024

- Completed DCF, WACC, and scenario analysis projects, including financial model automation and forecasting.

Power BI and Financial Modelling Webinars, Havas University | 2023

- Built KPI dashboards, scenario planning tools, and executive reporting frameworks.

AREAS OF STRENGTH

Optimizer – Drives financial efficiency, profitability, and risk mitigation by streamlining finance systems, optimizing processes, and aligning operating models with strategic and capital allocation objectives. Demonstrated ability to deliver measurable cost savings, faster close cycles, and improved forecast accuracy

Investigator & Assessor – Identifies hidden risks, control gaps, inefficiencies, and growth opportunities through rigorous financial analysis, credit and compliance assessment, portfolio review, and due diligence. Strong capability in evaluating investments, assessing downside risk, and strengthening governance and decision quality.

Analytical Problem-Solver – Delivers actionable solutions to complex financial and business challenges using structured analysis, scenario modelling, and predictive analytics.

Corporate Finance Strategist – Integrates FP&A, capital allocation, and investment evaluation to inform growth, M&A, and portfolio optimisation decisions across multi-entity operations

CAREER EXPERIENCE

Financial Reporting Manager Havas Group | Feb 2024 – June 2025

Role Overview: Reported to the CFO with accountability for FP&A, capital allocation, corporate finance advisory, investment strategy execution, and multi-entity financial reporting across African operations. Delivered executive-level insights to drive portfolio performance, strategic growth initiatives, and multi-currency, cross-border decision-making.

Key Contributions:

FP&A & Investment Analysis: Led budgeting, forecasting, variance analysis, and corporate finance advisory across USD, GBP, EUR, and NGN operations. Performed DCF, WACC, and investment evaluations to support portfolio oversight and disciplined capital deployment.

ERP Transformation & Automation: Migrated multi-entity financial operations to Adams ERP; automated reporting workflows and integrated cross-currency data, achieving 30% faster month-end close and 12% cost savings.

Predictive Revenue & Risk Analytics: Built advanced predictive forecasting, credit risk models, and scenario analysis tools to enhance revenue visibility, proactive risk management, and strategic investment decision support with 85%+ accuracy.

KPI Automation & FP&A Dashboard: Developed near real-time FP&A and KPI dashboards using Power BI and Python, reducing manual reporting effort by **30%** and improving forecast accuracy by **20%** and supporting scenario-based executive decision-making and investment performance dashboards.

Strategic Decision Support: Delivered actionable insights that enabled **25%** projected revenue growth, optimized capital allocation, and strengthened internal controls and governance frameworks.

ERP Transformation & Automation – Havas Group | 2024:

Achieved 30% faster month-end close and 12% cost savings.

Developed Power BI dashboards to track KPIs, scenario outcomes, and capital allocation.

Predictive Revenue & Risk Analytics – AI Internship | 2025

Built advanced predictive forecasting and credit risk models to improve revenue visibility and proactive risk management (analytics-led, business-owned).

Achieved 85%+ model accuracy, enabling proactive investment and risk management decisions.

Visualized insights in Python and Power BI dashboards for executive decision-making.

Investment & Valuation Simulation – Forage Virtual Projects | 2025

Conducted multi-scenario DCF and WACC analyses for simulated portfolio investments.

Applied scenario modeling to recommend capital allocation strategies.

Results informed risk-adjusted investment decisions in simulated cross-border projects.

KPI Automation & FP&A Dashboard – Havas Group | 2024–2025

Automated reporting across multiple ERP sources; created near real-time dashboards for management and CFO review. Reduced manual reporting effort by 30%, improved forecast accuracy by 20%, and enhanced transparency for decision-making.

Achievements:

Reduced month-end close cycle by 30% and improved forecast accuracy by 20%.

Enabled 25% projected revenue growth through FP&A-led insights and investment analysis.

Built finance-ready, visualizations using Python and Power BI to support forecasting, risk assessment, and strategic decision-making.

FINANCIAL SYSTEMS & ANALYTICAL TOOLS EXPERTISE

ERP & Accounting Systems: SAP, Oracle, Adams, Sage Pastel, QuickBooks, Xero, Navision, Magnitude

Business Intelligence & Analytics: Power BI (DAX, Power Query, visualization, reporting), Advanced Excel (pivot tables, macros, financial modelling), Tableau

Financial Platforms: SARS e-filing, Chase, Accpac, Pastel Payroll, Valuation software, IFRS reporting systems

Additional Attributes: Strategic thinker | Results-oriented | Data-driven decision-maker | Analytical | Proactive & innovative | Strong communication & interpersonal skills | Detail-oriented | Systems & risk-aware-focused | Attention to detail | Professional curiosity | Systems & risk-aware

CAREER EXPERIENCE

Finance & Business Strategy Manager – J Segel and Associates Inc | July 2025 to December 2025

Delivered corporate finance advisory, FP&A insights, and strategic business planning for SMEs and high-growth clients.

Key Achievements & Projects:

Conducted credit risk assessments, portfolio oversight, and investment due diligence.

Implemented finance transformation initiatives using ERP, AI, and automation tools to improve reporting and decision-making efficiency.

Applied scenario modeling to support capital allocation and ROI-focused investment strategies.

Delivered actionable FP&A insights and dashboards for senior leadership.

Finance & Advisory Leadership (FASSET) – DK Motiram & Company | Mar 2014 – Mar 2017

Provided strategic financial advisory, FP&A, and corporate finance support for multiple clients, including M&A engagements and cross-border operations.

Key Achievements:

Delivered process improvements, budgeting, forecasting, and variance analysis across client portfolios.

Supported investment strategy, portfolio management, and risk mitigation initiatives.

Advised clients on capital allocation decisions based on scenario planning and financial modeling outcomes.

Finance & Controls Training – Mahdi Meyer Steyn | 2013 – 2014

Developed expertise in FP&A, treasury, financial governance, and risk management processes.

Trainee Accountant (SAICA) – Waterman's Services | 2007 – 2012

Gained foundational experience in corporate finance, FP&A, audit, internal controls, and treasury management.

Additional Information:

Languages: English (Fluent), Afrikaans (Intermediate)

REFERENCES: Available upon request.